

CONNAR ELLINGTON

connarellington@gmail.com | Stockton-on-Tees, UK | 07305157505 | [LinkedIn](#)

SOC ANALYST PROFILE

Cybersecurity-focused professional with CompTIA CySA+ certification, combining hands-on SOC lab experience, enterprise Microsoft security exposure, and a strong foundation in threat detection, incident response, and log analysis.

Expertise in monitoring, analysing, and responding to security incidents across SIEM platforms and enterprise security infrastructures. Capable of identifying suspicious activities and executing incident response procedures in alignment with ITIL and cybersecurity best practices. Adept at correlating security events, escalating critical threats, and collaborating with cross-functional teams to proactively defend and strengthen organisational security posture. Proven ability to operate in fast-paced Security Operations Center environments while maintaining accuracy, compliance, and service-level expectations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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|--|-----------------------------------|-----------------------|
| • Security Operations Center Monitoring | • Security Event Monitoring | • Troubleshooting |
| • Threat Intelligence & Malware Analysis | • Network Traffic Analysis | • Configuration |
| • Endpoint Security & Access Control | • Identity & Access Management | • Risk Identification |
| • Vulnerability Assessment & Management | • Security Compliance & Reporting | • Team Collaboration |

CAREER EXPERIENCE

Selective Travel Management | Remote | 2025 - Present

IT Operations Engineer

Optimise Active Directory, Azure AD, and Microsoft 365 environments through advanced troubleshooting and system administration to ensure secure access, improved stability, and uninterrupted business operations. Execute patch deployment, system updates, and configuration enhancements across servers and endpoints to improve security compliance, minimise vulnerabilities, and enhance infrastructure performance.

- Contributed to successful achievement of Cyber Essentials Plus certification by supporting security compliance activities, vulnerability remediation, endpoint security practices, and IT operational controls across the business.
- Supported ISO 27001-aligned security and compliance initiatives, helping maintain security standards, documentation, and operational best practices within the IT Operations environment.
- Strengthened operational continuity through Tier 1 and Tier 2 technical support across critical business systems, accelerating incident remediation and minimising service disruption.
- Increased process efficiency via PowerShell-driven automation and optimisation of administrative tools.
- Restored system functionality and user productivity by diagnosing authentication failures, network connectivity issues, and endpoint performance bottlenecks.

Venator Materials | Wynyard, Stockton-on-Tees | 2024 - 2025

Global Service Desk Analyst

Provided first and second-line technical support to global users and senior leadership to ensure rapid issue resolution and uninterrupted business operations. Administered user accounts, access permissions, and mailboxes through Azure AD and Exchange Admin Center to maintain secure and efficient user management. Conveyed complex technical information to non-technical users with clarity to enhance understanding, user confidence, and issue resolution efficiency.

- Restored user productivity and minimised downtime by troubleshooting software, hardware, and network issues through EV and remote support platforms.

- Sustained infrastructure stability via cross-functional coordination with infrastructure, network, and security teams.

Virgin Media | Preston Industrial Park, Stockton-on-Tees | 2019 - 2024

Customer Retentions Advisor (Technical Support)

Applied advanced technical troubleshooting and network support skills to improve service stability, connection performance, and customer experience, contributing to a reduction in permanent service disconnections and customer churn. Communicated complex technical incidents to specialised support teams to ensure timely resolution and service continuity.

- Earned recognition for exceptional customer service and customer retention through consistent delivery of effective technical support and positive client experiences.
- Reduced engineer callouts and accelerated issue resolution by guiding customers through effective troubleshooting procedures.
- Strengthened onboarding effectiveness and team capability by coaching and mentoring newly hired staff.

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Event & Sales Management, Teesside University, Middlesbrough, 2015
NCFE Level 3 in Cyber Security Practices, Think Employment, 2023

HOME LAB & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

I operate personal home labs using VMware and VirtualBox to simulate enterprise environments for security monitoring and incident response. Within these labs, I configure Active Directory and Windows Server systems to generate realistic attack surfaces, then perform both defensive and offensive exercises through VulnHub, TryHackMe, and Hack The Box. My focus includes SIEM log analysis, alert triage, threat hunting, and incident documentation to mirror real SOC workflows. I continually expand my skills in threat detection, adversary tactics, and automation to strengthen my overall cyber-defence capability.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Cybersecurity Analyst (CySA+) CS0-003 — 2026

CompTIA A+ (220-1101 & 220-1102) — 2024

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (MS-900) — 2025

Microsoft Certified: Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900) — 2025

Introduction to Ethical Hacking — Code Academy, 2023

eJPT (Expected July 2026): Preparing for hands-on offensive security certification focusing on reconnaissance, enumeration, and exploitation using industry-standard tools.

JLPT N4 (In Progress): Developing Japanese language proficiency to support communication in multicultural and global cybersecurity environments.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

IT Support & Service Desk: Windows 10/11 setup | Ticketing systems | Remote access tools | ITIL principles | Incident Management

Systems Administration: Active Directory (AD) & Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) | Exchange Admin Center | Group Policy | PowerShell scripting | User provisioning | Access management | Microsoft Intune

Networking: TCP/IP | DNS | DHCP | VPN | Routers | Switches | Firewalls | LAN/WAN | Wi-Fi troubleshooting

Cybersecurity Fundamentals: Threat analysis | Log monitoring | SIEM (Splunk) | Windows Defender for Endpoint | Incident triage | Vulnerability assessment | Endpoint protection | Malware identification

Tools & Platforms: VMware | VirtualBox | Microsoft 365 | Windows Server 2016/2019 | PowerShell | Wireshark | Nmap